

Diego Castro Estrada

+1 (617) 586-5659

dcast230@fiu.edu / dicaes@mit.edu

diegocastroestrada.com

Education

B.S in Computer Science and Math, *Florida International University* (08/2019 – 12/2023)

- * Relevant Coursework: Real Analysis I and II, Mathematical Statistics, Machine Learning, Theory of Algorithms, Natural Language Processing, Mathematical Modelling, Numerical Analysis.
- * Cumulative GPA is 3.79/4.0

Experience

Undergraduate Researcher, *Cognac Lab FIU* (02/2020 – Present)

- * Worked on projects organized under SocialSim, a DARPA-funded initiative with the goal of providing high-fidelity simulations of online behavior in order to analyze and counter hostile narratives.
 - Participated in the creation of the GOLEM corpus, a dataset of $\sim 25K$ news articles annotated for motif analysis in narratives. Work under review for publication in LREC-Coling 2024.
 - Evaluated performance of Large Language Models at identifying unknown motifs in text to establish it as a challenging task for current SOTA methods.
 - Gathered data involving motif usage in Irish sport broadcasts in order to evaluate the incidence of motific events in in-group-affirming situations.
 - Worked on the creation of an NLP pipeline to automatically identify in-culture associations of a given (previously unknown) motif.
 - Collaborated on the design and ran experiment to quantify the ability of motifs to influence understanding of information of in-culture individuals. Work pending submission to *Journal of Memory and Language*.
 - Collaborated on the design and ran experiment to quantify the ability of out-culture individuals to identify unknown motific instances. Work pending submission to *Journal of Memory and Language*.

Resident Assitant, *Housing and Residential Experience FIU* (08/2023 – Present)

- * Jointly supervised all residents of Everglades Hall and was directly responsible for over 30 residents on the building's 4th floor.
 - Mediated roommate conflicts, achieving satisfactory solutions for all parties and maintained close relationships with residents, fostering a sense of community.
 - Organized events servicing the entirety of the university's housing community.

Summer Researcher, *AMRPU FIU* (06/2023 – 08/2023)

- * Discovered several novel ways of decomposing Riemannian submersions where the base manifold is locally-product-Riemannian into disjoint parts.
 - Established conditions for several properties of the resulting distributions including integrability, pluriharmonicity and total-geodesicity involving O'Neill tensors.
 - Work was presented at AMRPU conference.

Summer Researcher, *LIDS Lab MIT* (06/2021 – 12/2021)

- * Worked on the development of a mathematical framework for transfer learning with the preservation of constraints under the supervision of Drs. Asuman Ozdaglar and Alireza Fallah.
 - Designed test for empirical evaluation of potential training methods for constrained transfer learning.
 - Explored minimax formulation using constraint functions.
 - Presented poster at MSRP conference.

Publications

1. Yarlott, W. V. H., Ochoa, A., Acharya, A., Bobrow, L., **Castro Estrada, D.**, Gomez, D., Zheng, J., McDonald, D., Miller, C. & Finlayson, M. A. (2021). *Finding Trolls Under Bridges: Preliminary Work on a Motif Detector*. Advances in Cognitive Systems
2. Yarlott, W. V. H., Acharya, A., **Castro Estrada, D.**, Gomez, D. & Finlayson, M. A. (2023). *GOLEM: Gold standard for Learning and Evaluation of Motifs*. LREC-Coling 2024.
3. Acharya A., **Castro-Estrada D.**, Dahal S., Yarlott, W. V. H, Gomez, D., & Finlayson M. A. "2023 Discovering Implicit Meanings of Cultural Motifs from Text", *Under review at LaTeCH-CLfL 2024*.

Projects

Information Theoretic Inequality Prover

- * Worked on the design and development of a system using a modified version of Fourier-Motzkin elimination to automatically and accurately determine the validity of inequalities involving random variables and information theoretic functions of random variables.

Awards, Scholarships and Leadership

Awarded the FIU Presidential Scholarship.
Former President and former VP of the FIU Math Club.

Dean's List Fall 2019, Spring 2020, Fall 2020, Spring 2021, Fall 2021, Spring 2022
Honors College Dean's List Spring 2020, Fall 2020, Spring 2021, Fall 2021, Spring 2022.

Relevant Skills

Experienced in Python. Proficient at C and Java.
Fluent in English and Spanish. Speaks basic (A2) German.
Proficient at using well-known techniques to construct mathematical models of real-world phenomena.
Experienced at using HPC clusters to train machine learning models.

Experienced at designing, training and deploying machine learning models.

Experienced at learning complex concepts efficiently in order to adapt to changing responsibilities.

Experienced at analyzing unstructured text for narrative information.